

Philipp Hilbert. *Proxy Product Owner, Retail Banking Group.*

Positioning. Thirteen years translating complex regulated-domain requirements into shipped digital products, ready to do the same for Mashreq's retail banking journeys.

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Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Digital Product Expert / Proxy Product Owner role within Mashreq's Retail Banking Group. With thirteen years of product ownership across regulated industries, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, fintech, and secure government data, I have spent most of my career doing precisely what this role describes: sitting between business stakeholders and engineering squads, turning ambiguous requirements into working software, and keeping teams honest about sprint commitments.

The specific challenge in retail banking is that the compliance and governance surface is wide, the customer journey complexity is high, and delivery discipline has to hold across all of it simultaneously. I have operated in structurally similar environments. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, leading a cross-functional team of fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence, a programme where governance failure is not an option. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I held the additional role of Deputy IT Security Officer while managing a national analytics platform, which meant keeping engineering velocity up while satisfying audit and security requirements that could not be deferred. At AOK ITSCare I built and prioritised the backlog for a B2B procurement webshop on Shopware, writing user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira and carrying the migration through to production for roughly 20,000 end users, still running today.

What I bring specifically to a Proxy Product Owner role is the ability to hold two things at once that often come apart in practice: rigorous requirements definition and genuine technical depth. I can write a user story that a developer can implement without a follow-up conversation, and I can sit in a sprint planning session in Azure DevOps and challenge an estimate or a technical approach from a position of understanding rather than authority. I have used Azure DevOps as a delivery tool on multiple programmes, and I know the difference between a backlog that looks healthy and one that actually is.

On the AI-native side: I build internal tooling with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Cursor, and I use LLM-assisted spec generation to accelerate acceptance-criteria coverage on complex journeys, an approach that meaningfully reduces the rework loop between business requirements and implementation-ready stories.

I am an EU citizen based in Berlin, actively targeting Dubai and the UAE, and willing to relocate fully on-site. I am available at short notice.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
